

▶ pennsylvania byways

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▶ National Road

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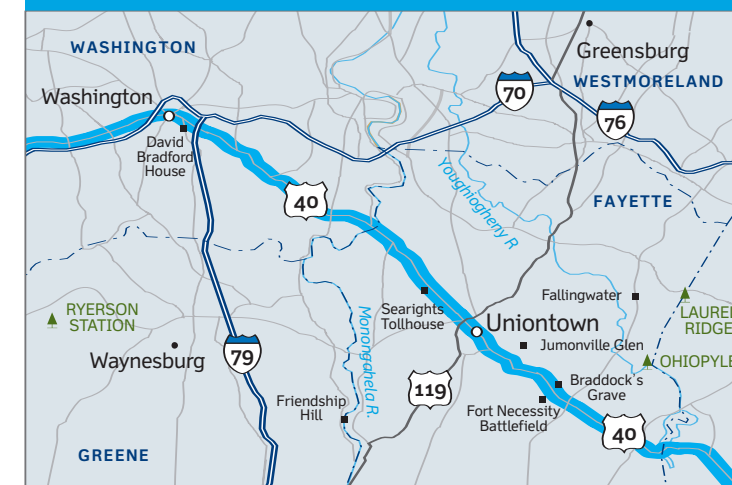
The Historic National Road is America's first federally funded highway – It is “The Road That Built The Nation.” The entire corridor covers over 800 miles, traveling from Cumberland, Maryland to Vandalia, Illinois.

The Historic National Road has its roots in early trails cut through the woods by Indians marking paths for George Washington and General Braddock. The Whiskey Rebellion started here in the 1790's. In the 1800's the “road” opened the land west of the Alleghenies to pioneers and traders.

Traversing 90 miles across Southwestern Pennsylvania, the National Road celebrates the history, culture and scenery of one of America's oldest byways. Various attractions along the National Road include Fort Necessity National Battlefield, Addison and Searights Tollhouses, the “S” Bridge, stone taverns and inns, and Nemacolin Castle. The National Road Heritage Corridor offers recreation, camping, historical sites, museums, antique shops, old churches and cemeteries, and amazing architecture.

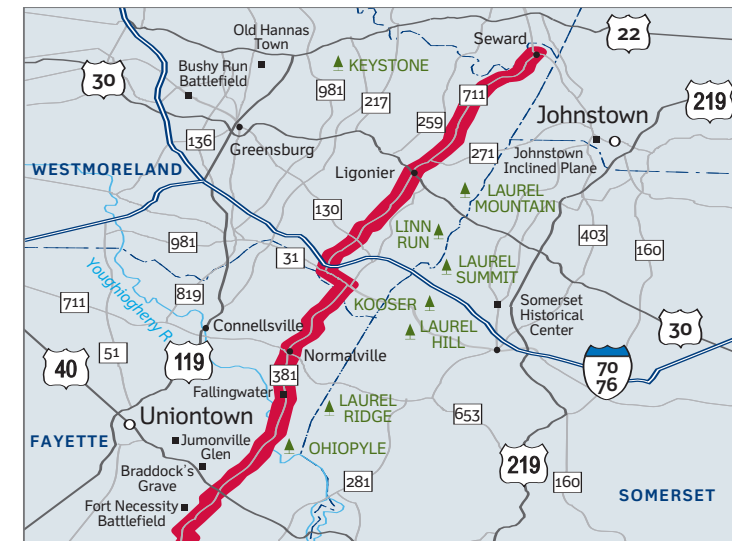


> detail map of the National Road



▶ Laurel Highlands

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> detail map of the Laurel Highlands Byway

A road trip along the 68-mile Laurel Highlands Scenic Byway takes you from rolling hillsides to rushing waterfalls and from picturesque farmlands to architectural wonders, the Laurel Highlands Scenic Byway has it all. With some of the best pedestrian and bicycle trails in the nation, the byway traveler should plan some time to leave their automobile to get a closer look at the natural beauty of the land.

Travelers have plenty of opportunities to journey by foot, bicycle, raft or railroad. There is so much to see along the byway, that the traveler will want to plan on an extended stay, and book a room at a quaint bed and breakfast or one of the region's famous resorts. Two of the more famous sights along the byway include the Frank Lloyd Wright masterpiece, Fallingwater®, and the Falls in Ohiopyle State Park.



Photo courtesy of the Western Pennsylvania Conservancy



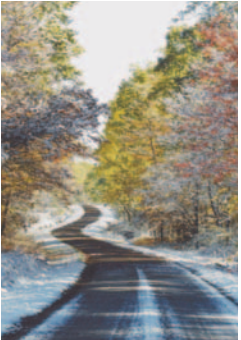
> Kinzua Bridge

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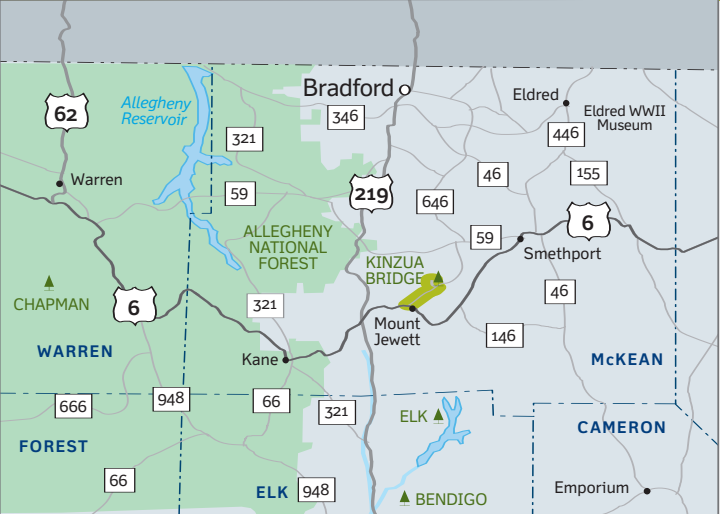
Enter this route just east of the town of Mt. Jewett on Pennsylvania’s scenic Route 6. Winding through the lush hardwood forest of the Alleghenies, you will pass by a maple syrup farm, wetlands and forests, and even a small dinosaur park before entering into the Kinzua Bridge State Park, home of the world famous Kinzua Viaduct.

When completed in 1882, the Kinzua Viaduct was acclaimed “the highest and longest railroad viaduct in the entire world.” Rising 301 feet from the valley floor at its center, with a total length of 2,053 feet, the viaduct is a Registered National Civil Engineering Landmark.

Emergency repair work was underway to preserve this national treasure, when on July 21, 2003 an F-1 tornado toppled 11 of the 20 towers of this historic structure. Where tracks and towers once spanned this mighty gorge, blue sky now separates the remaining portions of this engineering marvel.



> detail map of the Kinzua Bridge route



> Seaway Trail

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> detail map of Seaway Trail

This Lake Erie coastline route offers breathtaking views of Lake Erie and Presque Isle State Park, a 3,200-acre lush peninsula that reaches right out into Lake Erie. Hike, bike or roller-blade on the 14-mile multi-purpose trail; boat, fish or swim along 7 miles of unfettered surf beaches with world class sunsets. At the Stull Interpretive Center learn about this National Natural Landmark and its unique ecological composition.

Take a water taxi across Presque Isle Bay to downtown Erie’s Renaissance Bayfront District, home to the Maritime Museum and the U.S. Brig Niagara. Restaurants, festivals, lively arts, historic districts, lighthouses and amusement parks dot this PA coastline.

An extension of the New York Seaway Trail, a National Scenic Byway, visitors can travel the Seaway Trail along Route 5 through quaint towns and wine country in North East. This area is nationally recognized for its concord grapes and its harvesting of wine grapes by 5 local wineries.



> Grand View

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The road leading to Mt. Washington provides a panoramic view of downtown Pittsburgh and the Golden Triangle, the confluence of the Monongahela and Allegheny Rivers forming the Ohio River. As visitors scale the hillside, the lower elevations of McArdle Roadway offer a series of teasing views that become increasingly scenic and peak on the bluffs of Mt. Washington.

Atop Mt. Washington and along the byway, five pedestrian overlooks and two historic cable car railways (locally known as “incline”) are positioned along the length of Grandview Avenue. Visitors can stroll along the avenue or ride the inclines to experience the spectacular Pittsburgh vista. At night the byway’s grand view from Mt. Washington, with its sparkling skyline nestled among the City’s bridges, glistening rivers and lush mountains makes it easy to see why USA Weekend recently ranked it number two on their list of the “Top Ten Most Beautiful Places in America.”

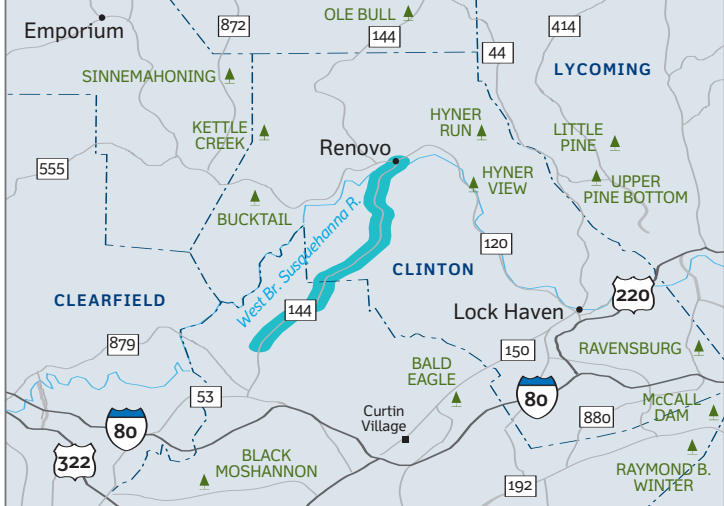


> detail map of the Grand View



> High Plateau - PA 144

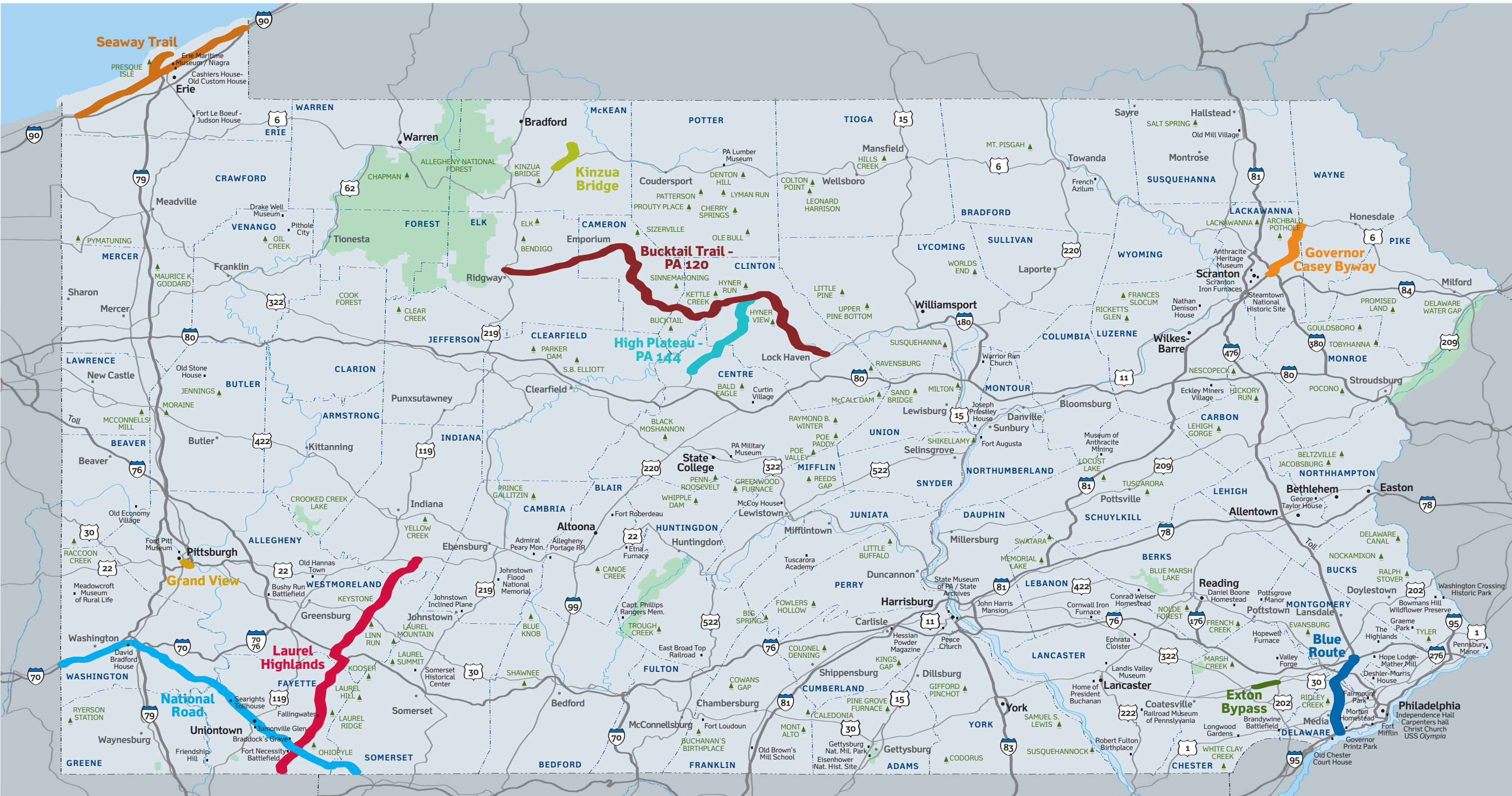
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> detail map of PA 144

This 27-mile corridor, located between Snow Shoe, (exit 147 off I-80), and Renovo, provides outstanding views of the Sprout State Forest as you travel on top of the high plateau of the Allegheny Ridge. This area of Pennsylvania is unspoiled by development and offers a vast expanse of hardwood forests interwoven with Evergreens and Mountain Laurel. With no power lines or homes visible from this most remote part of Pennsylvania, you can experience views unchanged for more than a hundred years. You are more apt to see wildlife such as deer, bear, or elk, than other people. The character of this byway is preserved because it passes near Burn’s Run and Fish Dam Wild Areas, as well as several natural areas. Recreational trails crisscross the byway and scenic vistas with parking offer you ideal locations to capture prize-winning photos or to do some hiking. There are no services on the byway until you reach Renovo and the Bucktail Trail Scenic Byway. Take your time and enjoy the views.





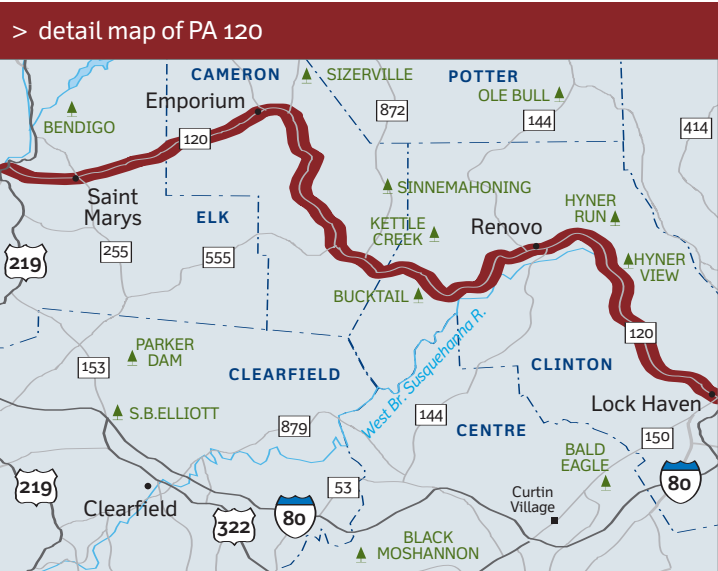
➤ Bucktail Trail - PA 120

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The Bucktail Scenic Byway stretches for 100 miles through the Sproul and Elk State Forests located in north central PA from Lock Haven to Ridgway. This byway follows the Old Sinnemahoning Trail used by Native Americans to travel between the West Branch Susquehanna and Allegheny Rivers.

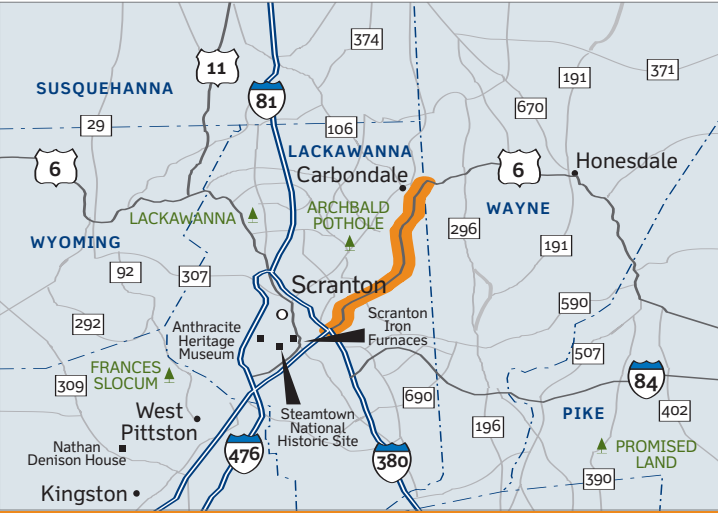
The byway is named after the Bucktail Rangers, a famous regiment of woodsmen that traveled this route to join the Union Army during the Civil War. Seven State Parks are within reach of this byway with access to hundreds of miles of remote hiking trails and many other outdoor recreational activities. The unspoiled forest-lands, beautiful hills and steep valleys are breathtaking at any time of the year but especially during the fall, when the foliage is alive with blazing colors. Watch for hang gliders as you near Hyner View and the majestic elk as you travel northwest of Renovo. Elk viewing sites are nearby at Winslow Hill and Sinnemahoning State Park.

Take your time and enjoy the hospitality of the small communities along your way.



➤ Governor Casey Byway

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> detail map of the Governor Casey Byway

Birds-eye views of majestic mountain-tops and the historic Lackawanna River Valley are what you'll experience as you cruise along the Governor Casey Scenic Byway in northeastern Pennsylvania. This once bustling industrial center revolutionized rail transportation and helped to give birth to our nation's western expansion.

At various stops along the highway, visitors can get in touch with the past at the historic sites and attractions that tell the story of our region's anthracite coal mining past and the evolution of the valley's close-knit ethnic communities. The Steamtown National Historic Site in Scranton is the only National Park Service site in the country dedicated to steam locomotion; other attractions like the Pennsylvania State Anthracite Heritage Museum and Iron Furnaces, Electric City Trolley Museum and Lackawanna County Coal Mine Tour give visitors a firsthand look at what life was like in 19th-century Northeastern Pennsylvania.



Photo courtesy of Steamtown National historic Site



Photo courtesy of Lackawanna County

➤ Blue Route

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The journey into Delaware County's Brandywine Country is convenient and beautiful thanks to our "Blue Route." Decades in the making, and originally three different routes (red, yellow and blue), the blue route (I-476) prevailed to finally link the Pennsylvania Turnpike and I-95. This aesthetically pleasing route is both resident and tourist friendly.

History and culture come alive along this scenic route. A 1770's PA Colonial Plantation, in beautiful Ridley Creek State Park, offers visitors a glimpse of colonial life. The 1724 Old Chester Courthouse, in historic Chester, is the oldest public building in continuous use in the United States.

The Media Theatre for the Performing Arts is also minutes from this route. A magnificently restored 1927 theater, the Media Theatre is home to Broadway musicals, concert events and a renowned theater camp.

Finally a host of museums and gardens, such as the famed Brandywine River Museum, Tyler Arboretum and Longwood Gardens, can be easily accessed thanks to our "Blue Route."



➤ Exton Bypass

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> detail map of the Exton Bypass

As you travel through the rolling hills of Chester County, you will notice open landscapes that have been preserved. We offer many back roads to enjoy the scenic grandeur of the Brandywine Valley. The Exton Bypass is located just 4 miles north of West Chester.

Two top attractions in West Chester are the QVC Studio Tour, which gives you a chance to get a behind-the-scenes look at the world's largest electronic retailer, and the American Helicopter Museum, next-door, which is a favorite for children of all ages. You can climb aboard the interactive hands-on helicopters.

